Pentagon off their backs, but it was disgraceful by any other yardstick. Thankfully, Keller came back the next day with an agreement to lay off that sort of thing and they did for a while.

It later emerged, via the guys at *Der Spiegel*, that the *Guardian* had been ready to fuck us all along. They were working with the *New York Times* and were willing to go without even telling us, and without giving us a chance to prepare the data properly or prepare ourselves for attack. That's how much the *Guardian* actually cared for the principles involved. Openness? You must be joking. A new generation of libertarians? They couldn't have cared less. A new mood of popular uprisings in the world and a new spirit of speaking truth to power? The *Guardian* – the most ill-named paper in the world – may carry picture after picture from Tahrir Square, but they were willing to sell all the principles that movement stood for, and that we stood for in helping them, straight down the river. The senior news reporter's attempt to give his paper one last leg-up before retirement left his paper gasping for its liberal breath. When American right-wingers were calling for me to be killed, the *Guardian* didn't run a single article in my defence. Instead, they got my old friend, the special investigations reporter, to write a dirty little attack on me.

'Strewth,' as we used to say. Life was easier when it was just sugar ants running up my legs and biting me to death. At least in those days I had the sun on my side. But in our new kind of business, you soon get over the old guard kicking you when you're down. We had a month to get the cables in good order, and doing so would be the most exhilarating month of my life. The cables would show the modern world what it really thought of itself, and we worked through the nights in an English country house to meet the deadline. The snow had begun to fall and it lay evenly over the Norfolk countryside. There was no way to know back then that the house was soon to become my prison for the foreseeable future.